STUDY AID · MATTHEW 22:1-14 · EPISODE 43 (#46 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)

Dressed for *the Wedding*

Many are called, few are chosen

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 22:1-14 in the LSB | 30:22 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The Hidden Meaning Behind the Wedding Feast. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 22:1-14. A king gives a wedding feast for his son and sends slaves to call those already invited, but they refuse. Some go off to their farms and business; others seize and kill the slaves. The king sends his armies, destroys the murderers and burns their city. Then he sends his slaves to the main highways to gather everyone they find, both evil and good, and the hall is filled. But one guest has no wedding clothes. Speechless, he is bound and thrown into the outer darkness. 'For many are called, but few are chosen.'
- The leaders had just left (Mark 12:12), so the video thinks Jesus now speaks mainly to the crowds and disciples. Luke 14:16-24 tells a similar parable at a dinner. 'Called' means already invited: the first guests had accepted an invitation and then refused to come.
- 'Worthy' runs through Matthew: bear fruit worthy of repentance (3:8), a worthy house (10:11-13), and whoever loves family more than Jesus is not worthy of Him (10:37-38). Those gathered from the highways were both evil and good, like the wheat and tares.
- The wedding clothes were provided; the guest refused to put them on. Isaiah 61:10 pictures God clothing His people with garments of salvation and a robe of righteousness, the way a bridegroom puts on a priest-like headdress. Zephaniah 1:8 warns of punishment on all who clothe themselves with foreign garments: idolatry and mixed allegiance.

> *"To be worthy of God's kingdom, you must remove all your idols and foreign allegiances and allow the Lord to fully consecrate or fully clothe you with his righteousness."*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"The proper clothes were made available to him, but he refused to put them on."*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- The lesson: to be worthy of God's kingdom, you must remove all your idols and foreign allegiances and allow the Lord to fully consecrate, or fully clothe, you with His righteousness.

Trace a picture through Scripture

Clothing runs from Eden to the prophets: fig leaves and garments of skin, the robe of righteousness, foreign garments. Following the picture shows what the wedding clothes mean.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 43 of the Matthew study (playlist item 46).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 22:1-14 and turns to Mark 12, Luke 14, Matthew 3, 6, 7, 10 and 13, Isaiah 61, Ezekiel 16, Genesis 3, Zephaniah 1 and 3, Exodus 20, Acts 9 and James 1. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 22:1-14
Read in full: the parable of the wedding feast.

Mark 12:12
The leaders leave.

Luke 14:16-24
A similar parable of a big dinner.

Matthew 3:8
Fruit worthy of repentance.

Matthew 10:11-13
A worthy house.

Matthew 10:37-38
Not worthy of Me.

Matthew 13:41-42
The tares gathered out.

Isaiah 61:6
Priests of Yahweh.

Isaiah 61:10
Garments of salvation, a robe of righteousness.

Ezekiel 16:10
God clothes His people.

Genesis 3:7
Fig-leaf coverings.

Genesis 3:21
Garments of skin.

Zephaniah 1:4-8

Zephaniah 3:3

Foreign garments.

Wolves at evening.

Exodus 20:2-3
No other gods.

Acts 9:2
The Way.

Matthew 7:15-23
Wolves in sheep's clothing.

James 1:6-8
Double-minded.

Matthew 6:24
No one can serve two masters.

Key verses in the LSB

"The kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who gave a wedding feast for his son."
Matthew 22:2 (LSB)

"For He has clothed me with garments of salvation, / He has wrapped me with a robe of righteousness,"
Isaiah 61:10 (LSB)

"For many are called, but few are chosen."
Matthew 22:14 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The king's wedding feast

Called and unwilling, not worthy, and the guests from the highways.

MATTHEW 22:1-6

Called, and unwilling

MATTHEW 22:3-5 (LSB)

INVITATION

"And he sent out his slaves to call those who had been called to the wedding feast, and they were unwilling to come. Again he sent out other slaves saying, 'Tell those who have been called, "Behold, I have prepared my dinner; my oxen and my fattened livestock are all butchered and everything is ready; come to the wedding feast."' But they paid no attention and went their way, one to his own farm, another to his business,"

FROM THE VIDEO 'Called' means they were already invited and had said yes. When the feast was ready, they refused to come.

FROM THE VIDEO Some just got distracted by farm and business. Others seized and killed the slaves, as the vine-growers did in the last parable (21:35).

BACKGROUND The rabbis told a similar parable: 'The situation is comparable to a king who invited his servants to a feast and did not set a time for them to come' (Talmud Shabbat 153a), credited to Rabban Yoḥanan ben Zakkai.

◆ Factbook: Messianic banquet ◆ Factbook: Babylonian Talmud

MATTHEW 22:7-8

Not worthy

THE KING · MATTHEW 22:8

“Then he *said to his slaves, ‘The wedding is ready, but those who were called were not worthy.”

JOHN THE BAPTIST · MATTHEW 3:8

“Therefore bear fruit in keeping with repentance;”

FROM THE VIDEO Worthiness runs through Matthew: fruit in keeping with repentance (3:8), a worthy house (10:11-13), and 'he who loves father or mother more than Me is not worthy of Me' (10:37). Matthew 10:11-13

BACKGROUND 'Set their city on fire' (22:7) has long been read as a picture of Jerusalem's fall in AD 70.

◆ Factbook: Repentance ◆ Factbook: John the Baptist

MATTHEW 22:9-10

Both evil and good

MATTHEW 22:9-10 (LSB)

HIGHWAYS

“Go therefore to the main highways, and as many as you find there, call to the wedding feast.’ And those slaves went out into the streets and gathered together all they found, both evil and good; and the wedding hall was filled with dinner guests.”

FROM THE VIDEO The main roads are where the poor and outsiders gather. The invitation goes to everyone.

FROM THE VIDEO 'Both evil and good' sounds like the wheat and tares: until the end, the gathered people are mixed (13:41-42). Matthew 13:41-42

BACKGROUND Luke's dinner parable sends the slave for 'the poor and crippled and blind and lame' (Luke 14:21).

◆ Factbook: Weeds (tares, darnel) ◆ Factbook: Gentiles



Go therefore to the main highways

Bernardo Strozzi, Parable of the Wedding Feast, 1636. Via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“In Zephaniah, your clothes represent your allegiance.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The wedding clothes

Speechless, a robe of righteousness, foreign garments, and called and chosen.

MATTHEW 22:11-13

No wedding clothes

MATTHEW 22:11-13 (LSB)

SPEECHLESS

““But when the king came in to look over the dinner guests, he saw a man there who was not dressed in wedding clothes, and he *said to him, ‘Friend, how did you come in here without wedding clothes?’

And the man was speechless. Then the king said to the servants, ‘Bind him hand and foot, and throw him into the outer darkness; in that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’”

FROM THE VIDEO The guests came straight from the roads, so the king must have provided the garments. This man was given the clothes; he refused to put them on.

FROM THE VIDEO He has no answer. He is speechless because he has no excuse.

◆ Factbook: Outer darkness



ISAIAH 61:10

A robe of righteousness

ISAIAH 61:10 (LSB)

REMEZ

“I will rejoice greatly in Yahweh; / My soul will rejoice in my God, / For He has clothed me with garments of salvation, / He has wrapped me with a robe of righteousness, / As a bridegroom decks himself with a headdress, / And as a bride adorns herself with her jewels.”

FROM THE VIDEO The wedding garment is righteousness that God provides. In Isaiah 61:10 the word for 'decks' (kahan) is related to the word for priest: the bridegroom dresses like a priest. Isaiah 61:6

FROM THE VIDEO God clothes His people in Ezekiel 16:10 too. In Eden, Adam and Eve made fig-leaf coverings (Genesis 3:7), but Yahweh God made garments of skin and clothed them (3:21). Ezekiel 16:10 Genesis 3:7 Genesis 3:21

◆ Factbook: Bridegroom ◆ Factbook: Righteousness ◆ Factbook: Adam ◆ Factbook: Eve



ZEPHANIAH 1:7-8

Foreign garments

ZEPHANIAH · ZEPHANIAH 1:7

“Be silent before Lord Yahweh! / For the day of Yahweh is near, / For Yahweh has prepared a sacrifice; / He has set apart His guests.”

ZEPHANIAH · ZEPHANIAH 1:8

““Then it will be on the day of Yahweh’s sacrifice / That I will punish the princes, the king’s sons, / And all who clothe themselves with foreign garments.”

FROM THE VIDEO Zephaniah's feast has invited guests too, and judgment on those dressed in foreign clothes. The context (1:4-6) is Baal worship and swearing by Milcom alongside Yahweh: mixed allegiance. Zephaniah 1:4-6

FROM THE VIDEO Giving allegiance to the Lord and to idols at the same time is syncretism, and the first commandment rejects it: 'You shall have no other gods before Me' (Exodus 20:3). Exodus 20:3

BACKGROUND Zephaniah also calls Jerusalem's judges 'wolves at evening' (Zephaniah 3:3), which the video links to the wolves in sheep's clothing of Matthew 7:15. Zephaniah 3:3 Matthew 7:15

◆ Factbook: Zephaniah (the prophet) ◆ Factbook: Baal (storm god) ◆ Factbook: Wolf



MATTHEW 22:14; 6:24

Called and chosen

JESUS · MATTHEW 22:14

JESUS · MATTHEW 6:24

“For many are called, but few are chosen.””

““No one can serve two masters; for either he will hate the one and love the other, or he will be devoted to one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and wealth.”

FROM THE VIDEO Many accept the invitation; fewer let God clothe them completely. A double-minded person is 'unstable in all his ways' (James 1:8). James 1:8

FROM THE VIDEO Halakha, Jewish law, comes from the verb 'to walk,' and the first believers were called 'the Way' (Acts 9:2). The garment is a way of life. Acts 9:2

◆ Factbook: Halakha ◆ Factbook: Mammon



Friend, how did you come in here without wedding clothes?

Unknown artist, Parable of the Royal Wedding, print, c. 1700. Rijksmuseum, Amsterdam, via Wikimedia Commons, CC0

> *“The proper clothes were made available to him, but he refused to put them on.*
>
> From the video

05

Who's who in 22:1-14

What the video says, then a short background note.

The king

VIDEO God the Father, who gives the feast for His Son.

BACKGROUND Compare the king in the parable of 18:23.

The son

VIDEO Jesus, the bridegroom.

BACKGROUND Jesus calls Himself the bridegroom in 9:15.

Matthew 9:15 ◆ Bridegroom

Matthew 22:2 ◆ Parable of the wedding banquet

The slaves

VIDEO The prophets and messengers sent to call the guests.

BACKGROUND Mistreated and killed, like the slaves in 21:35-36.

Matthew 22:3-6 Matthew 21:35-36

◆ The Prophets (books)

Those who were called

VIDEO Invited, but unwilling; the leaders and those who rejected Him.

BACKGROUND Luke's version has excuses about a field, oxen and a wife (Luke 14:18-20).

Luke 14:18-20

The guests from the highways

VIDEO Evil and good, the poor and outsiders.

BACKGROUND Compare Luke 14:21-23.

Matthew 22:9-10 Luke 14:21-23

The man without wedding clothes

VIDEO Accepted the call but refused the garment provided.

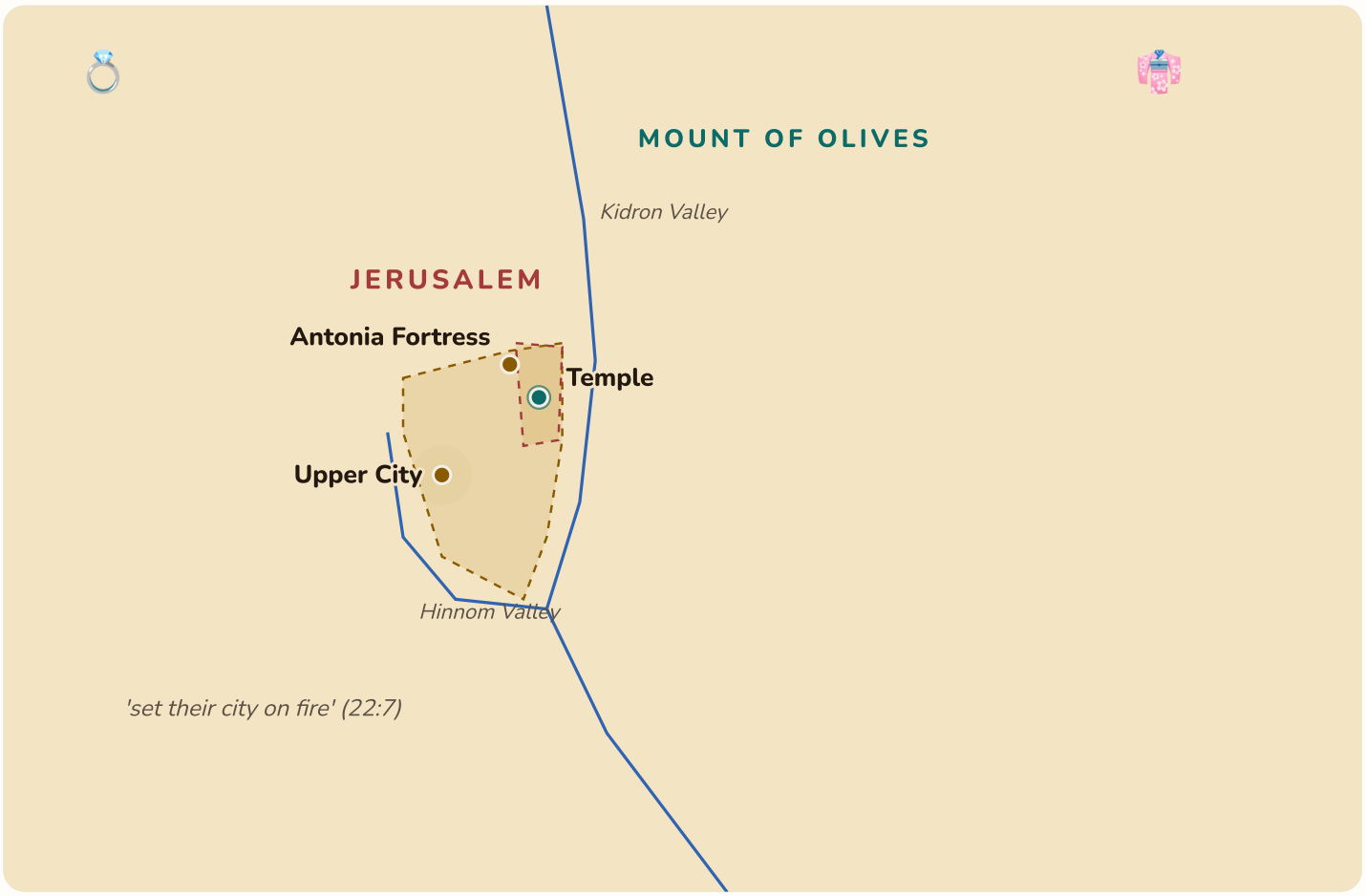
BACKGROUND The king calls him 'Friend' (22:12), as the landowner did in 20:13.

Matthew 22:12 Matthew 20:13

06 · BACKGROUND

The city in the parable

A close-up map of Jerusalem, where Jesus told the parable. Pins outlined in the video's color are places in this passage.



● Named in the video ● Background

Schematic: drawn for this study from known sites. Walls (gold dashes) and the temple platform (coral dashes) are approximate for the first century.

Temple VIDEO
Jesus is teaching in the temple courts (21:23; 22:1).

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

Antonia Fortress BACKGROUND
Roman garrison beside the temple; in AD 70 Titus's legions took it first.

◆ Factbook: Tower of Antonia

Upper City BACKGROUND
Wealthy quarter, burned in AD 70.

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem

07

Key terms

Wedding feast

VIDEO

A celebration that could last days; here a picture of the messianic banquet.

Called

VIDEO

Invited; in 22:14 'called' (klētos) is set against 'chosen' (eklektos).

◆ Factbook: Messianic banquet ◆ Factbook: Marriage

◆ Factbook: Parable of the wedding banquet

Wedding clothes

VIDEO

Festive clothing for the feast; in the video, righteousness that God provides.

◆ Factbook: Righteousness

Foreign garments

VIDEO

In Zephaniah 1:8, clothing tied to foreign worship and loyalties.

◆ Factbook: Zephaniah (the prophet)

◆ Factbook: Idolatry

Syncretism

VIDEO

Mixing the worship of the true God with other gods or loyalties.

◆ Factbook: Baal (storm god) ◆ Factbook: Idolatry

Halakha

VIDEO

Jewish law and practice; from the Hebrew verb 'to walk.'

◆ Factbook: Halakha

08 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

γάμος

gamos G1062

Wedding, wedding feast.

Greek · Matt 22:2, 8

◆ Factbook: Marriage

ἔνδυμα

endyma G1742

Garment, clothing.

Greek · Matt 22:11, 12

φιμόω

phimoō G5392

To muzzle, silence; 'speechless.'

Greek · Matt 22:12

κλητός

klētos G2822

Called, invited.

Greek · Matt 22:14

ἐκλεκτός

eklektos G1588

Chosen, elect. Look up: BDAG, ἐκλεκτός.

ἐξώτερος

exōteros G1857

Outer, outside.

Greek · Matt 22:14

Greek · Matt 22:13

◆ Factbook: Outer darkness

ἄξιος

axios G514

Worthy, fitting.

Greek · Matt 22:8

כָּהַן

kahan H3547

To act as priest; in Isa 61:10 'decks' (himself). Look up: BDB, כָּהַן.

Hebrew · Isa 61:10

◆ Factbook: Priest

נָכְרִי

nokhri H5237

Foreign, alien.

Hebrew · Zeph 1:8

מַלְבּוּשׁ

malbush H4403

Garment, clothing.

Hebrew · Zeph 1:8

09

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Two invitations

In the ancient world a host often sent an invitation in advance and then a second call when the meal was ready. Refusing the second call after accepting the first was a public insult.

A rabbinic parallel

The Talmud credits Rabban Yoḥanan ben Zakkai with a parable of a king's feast with no set time: 'The wise among them entered before him adorned in their finest clothes, and the fools entered before him dirty' (Talmud Shabbat 153a). There the clothes stand for readiness through repentance.

Garments and identity

In Scripture clothing often marks status and loyalty: priestly garments, mourning sackcloth, the robe given to the returning son (Luke 15:22). Zephaniah's 'foreign garments' shows clothing could signal foreign worship.

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> ***For the garment is life and practice.***

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 69, on 22:11-13. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *although to be called and to be cleansed was of grace, yet, when called and clothed in clean garments, to continue keeping them so, this is of the diligence of them that are called.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 69, on 22:11-14. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

Who provided the garment?

There is no clear first-century evidence that hosts supplied wedding clothes, though some point to royal gifts of robes (2 Kings 10:22). Many read the point as the guest's refusal, whoever supplied the clothing.

What is the garment?

Readers have taken it as imputed righteousness, as a changed life (Chrysostom), or both. The video combines them: God clothes, and the guest must not wear anything foreign.

Is the city Jerusalem?

Many see 22:7 as a picture of AD 70; others see a stock feature of royal punishment stories.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Wolves in sheep's clothing are in Matthew 7:15-16; the video says 17:15-16.
- The video gives the Jewish levels of reading as peshat, remez and sod; the usual list is four (peshat, remez, derash, sod), and the acronym PaRDeS is medieval.
- Fig-leaf coverings are Adam and Eve's own work (Genesis 3:7); God clothes them in 3:21.
- Matthew 22:1 says Jesus 'spoke to them again,' and 22:15 shows the Pharisees still near, so whether the audience changed after Mark 12:12 is debated.
- That the king supplied the wedding garments is an inference; the parable does not say it.

10 · BACKGROUND

From Eden to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 22:1-14 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

BEGINNING

God makes garments of skin for Adam and Eve

Genesis 3:21

c. 700 BC DEBATED

Isaiah: a robe of righteousness

Isaiah 61:10 *Remez: 22:11*

c. 640-609 BC DEBATED

Zephaniah: foreign garments

Zephaniah 1:8 *Remez: 22:11*

c. AD 30 DEBATED

The parable of the wedding feast

Matthew 22:1-14 *This episode*

AD 70

Jerusalem burned by Rome

Matthew 22:7

c. AD 70-80 DEBATED

Rabban Yoḥanan ben Zakkai's king's-feast parable (recorded later)

Matthew 22:2

c. AD 390

Chrysostom: 'the garment is life and practice'

Matthew 22:11

11

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Revelation 19:7-9

The marriage supper of the Lamb; fine linen

ADDED

Galatians 3:27

Clothed yourselves with Christ

ADDED

Zechariah 3:3-5

Filthy garments removed, festal robes given

ADDED

Colossians 3:9-14

Put off the old, put on the new

ADDED

Isaiah 25:6-9

A feast for all peoples on this mountain

ADDED

12

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. [ ] Why would people who accepted an invitation refuse to come when the feast was ready?
2. [ ] What 'farms and businesses' most easily distract you from God's call?
3. [ ] How do Genesis 3:21 and Isaiah 61:10 shape your picture of the wedding clothes?
4. [ ] What 'foreign garments' or mixed allegiances are common today?
5. [ ] How do grace and diligence fit together in Chrysostom's comment?
6. [ ] What does it mean for you to be fully clothed by God this week?

13

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: to be worthy of God's kingdom, you must remove all your idols and foreign allegiances and allow the Lord to fully consecrate or fully clothe you with His righteousness. In Zephaniah, your clothes represent your allegiance; if your allegiance is to the one true God, it cannot be to anyone or anything else. God's covering of His people is relational and covenantal, going back to Eden. The man in the parable had the proper clothes made available and refused to put them on. No one can serve two masters, and a double-minded man is unstable in all his ways.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

list one loyalty that competes with God for your time or trust. Pray Isaiah 61:10 over it this week and take one concrete step to set it aside.

> *"To be worthy of God's kingdom, you must remove all your idols and foreign allegiances and allow the Lord to fully consecrate or fully clothe you with his righteousness.*
>
> From the video

14

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ John the Baptist ◆ Isaiah ◆ Pharisees ◆ Repentance ◆ Judgment ◆ Righteousness ◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Adam ◆ Eve ◆ Garden of Eden ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Worship ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Gentiles ◆ Mammon ◆ Oath ◆ Prayer ◆ Babylonian Talmud ◆ Valley of Hinnom ◆ Bridegroom ◆ Halakha ◆ Messianic banquet ◆ Outer darkness ◆ Priest ◆ Wolf ◆ Zephaniah (the prophet) ◆ Mourning ◆ Parable ◆ Rabbi ◆ Baal (storm god) ◆ Day of the Lord ◆ Sackcloth ◆ Weeds (tares, darnel) ◆ Wheat ◆ Marriage ◆ Tower of Antonia ◆ Idolatry ◆ Milcom (Molech) ◆ Mount of Olives ◆ Parable of the wedding banquet ◆ Parable of the wicked tenants ◆ Yohanan ben Zakkai

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